TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 13, 2021
6:30 PM

1. **Call to order –**

   Mayor Goette called the meeting to order at 6:29 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those in attendance was; Mayor Beth Goette and Council Members Dana Williams, Dave Crenshaw, Larry Ward and John Henry. Staff in attendance was; Interim Town Administrator, Molly Sims; Accounts Payable/Utilities Clerk, Katina Spaulding; Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Police Chief, Sean Clayton and Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion. Attending virtually was Council Member, Ed Drohan and Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda –**

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of December 9, 2020

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the December 9, 2020 meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Kimberly Chappell-Stevens Memorial Dedication –**

   Council Member Williams and Mayor Goette presented a framed portrait that will hang in the Council Chambers, to the family of former Council Member Kimberly Chappell-Stevens. Council Member Williams read since its inception, the Town of Thunderbolt has had some great leaders and visionaries who have helped to shape and preserve this Town and our way of life. In 1675, borrowing from a statement made by Bernard of Charles, Sir Isaac Newton stated, "If I have seen further it is by standing on the shoulders of giants." If you were fortunate enough to have known Kimberly Chappell Stevens, then you know that she was definitely a giant and that we have without a doubt seen further because of her! Kimberly was the perfect example of how an elected official should conduct themselves. She was fair and impartial and she always made decisions based on facts and sound judgment rather than letting her feelings and emotions govern her decisions. Kimberly loved this Town and everyone in it and she believed in progress while preserving our heritage and traditions. It is my sincerest hope that everyone

who holds public office, both here and elsewhere, would follow her good example. The world would undoubtedly be a better place if we all did. As a testament to her devoted service and as a reminder to all who serve our Town and its Citizens, and on the behalf of the Honorable Mayor Beth Goette, Town Aldermen, staff and the citizens of the Town of Thunderbolt, it is my distinct Honor to dedicate this Memorial to our beloved friend and colleague Kimberly Chappell Stevens to preside over this chamber in perpetuity. Godspeed My dear Friend, We Love you and miss you!

Former Council Member Chappell-Stevens' son, Franklin expressed his gratitude for all the kindness that was shown. It reinforces how great this Town can be.

6. **Discussion with Ben Wall, Atlantic Waste –**

Ben Wall from Atlantic Waste gave an update on sanitation services. Mr. Wall stated Atlantic Waste has been in Thunderbolt 5 or 6 years. Thunderbolt was the first municipality to contract with Atlantic Waste. Mr. Wall explained the changes in recycling with China not accepting our recyclables. Other change was the closing of the inert landfill. Inert trash now is going to regular landfill. Council Member Drohan asked about every other week recycling. Mr.Wall stated he looked into this and does not recommend reducing service. Recycling is a highly used service. The only place there have been recycling issues has been the trailer park. Mr. Wall stated he is working with staff to address the issue. The recycling bin is used as a second trash can. Mr. Wall does suggest combining trash collection with yard waste. Current collection is not at capacity and can add yard waste to fill the trucks. This will reduce the number of trucks on the road and will reduce cost $1 per resident. Council Member Crenshaw asked what would they do if they filled to capacity. Mr. Wall explained the truck will come back. Council Member Henry asked if we would use separate carts? Mr. Wall stated it would not make a difference. They will dispose of both on the same day. Council Member Ward asked if there would be a limit to disposal. Wall explained it would be same as current requirements. Mayor Goette asked how is current requirements are handled. Mr. Wall explained the resident is to pay for overages before they come to pick it up. Council Member Williams pointed out in the past that if the pile is more than allowed, they have left it for the next pick up. Mayor Goette asked if Council needs to vote to combine trash day with yard debris and asked if down the line it does not work out can it be reverted back. Town Attorney Barrow stated there needs to be an amendment to the contract. Mr. Wall stated if the Town does not like combining the it can go back. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated she is in agreement with the change. **Council Member Crenshaw made a motion to approve the proposal on contingency of Town Attorney approving the amendment to the contract. Council Member Williams seconded he motion**. Council Member Drohan commented he has one concern with the seasonal increase in yard waste and asked will there still be restraints during this time? Mr. Wall stated they will monitor and can use other trucks on a seasonal bases. **The motion passed unanimously.**

7. **Approval of Renewal of Home Occupation Licenses for Anderson VIP Concierge and First Realty**

Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the home occupation licensees for Anderson VIP Concierge and First Realty on 3614 Macceo Dr. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed**

8. **Approval of New Home Occupation License for Sublime Massage & Bodywork**

Mayor Goette asked if the petitioners were at the meeting. They were not. Mayor Goette asked if staff had received a copy of the message therapist license and Clerk of Council Denion stated she did. Mayor Goette had questions for the petitioner concerning parking. **Council Member Ward made the motion to table the petition till next meeting and Council Member Henry seconded the motion.** Council Member Henry asked staff to required the petitioner to attend on the application. **The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Approval to apply for Firehouse Subs Grant**

Interim Town Administrator Sims explained the application requires approval from Council to submit the grant application. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the submission of the grant with a second by Council Member Henry. The motion passed unanimously.**

10. **Appointment for Al Henderson's Council Seat –**

Mayor Goette read Council Member Henderson's resignation letter. Four residents have shown an interest and have submitted their resume. Those resumes have been distributed to Council. Each nominee spoke of their credentials and why they wish to be on Council.

Greggory Brooks Barbaree 3310 Lois St – see attached resume

Kristen Johnson – 3212 Gragg St. – see attached resume

Rebecca Dayoub – 3005 River Drive #306 – see attached resume

Leslie Lunney – 3005 River Drive #514 – see attached resume

Mayor asked if it is Councils wish to make a nomination tonight. Asked if there are any comments. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to nominate Brooks Barbaree to be the replacement of Al Henderson's seat on Council. Council Member Henry seconded the motion.** Council Member Drohan asked for a discussion. Mayor Goette gave him the go ahead. Council Member Drohan stated he is overwhelmed by the intelligent individuals that have volunteer. Explained he spoke with Ms. Johnson on his front porch. He reminded the Town has an election soon. The talk on the street is there will be several vacancies. He encouraged those not appointed to considered running. Council Member Crenshaw pointed out Planning & Zoning still has two vacancies if anyone of the nominee's wish to be appointed. Council Member Williams reiterated what the others have said. Most of the time it is a thankless job. It is rewarding to be a part of something bigger than ourselves. We need good people to carry the torch moving forward. Mayor Goette called for the vote. **The motion passed unanimously.**

Mayor Goette swore in Brooks Barbaree and he took a seat with the rest of the Council Members.

11. **Finance Report**:

a) Municipal Tax Collections in 2020

Tax Years 2011-2019	$ 50,769.71
Tax Year 2020	$ 617,339.61

b) Municipal Tax Outstanding as of December 31, 2020

Tax Years 2011-2019	$ 26,070.27
Tax Year 2020	$ 68,892.32

Town Attorney Barrow and Interim Town Administrator Sims met with Danny McIntosh about the library contract. Council Member Ward asked if Mr. McIntosh had any contacts. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated he has had some interest. It was stated major utility items need to be addressed by the Town.

Interim Town Administrator Sims explained that as of Dec. 31, 2020 COVID leave expired. She recommends to provide the extension of some of this leave till March 31st. This would be for employees test COVID or has symptoms and waiting on test results. Council Member Crenshaw stated he agreed with Interim Town Administrator Sims'

recommendation. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to accept the recommendation for sick leave extension to March 31, 2021. The motion passed unanimously.**

12. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

    by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**
    Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
    Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager
    Council Member Crenshaw asked the results from the smoke test. Public Works Manager Crosby stated letters were sent out. Council Member Crenshaw asked how many residents received letters. Public Works Manager Crosby stated 32. Mayor Goette asked if we needed to report this to EPD. Public Work Manger Crosby stated they did not. Council Member Crenshaw asked about testing of well number 3. Public Works Manager Crosby stated Town has not used the well much. Council Member Crenshaw wanted to know how long does Public Works Manager Crosby run the well before taking samples. Public Works Manager Crosby stated the well runs about 15 min before pulling water sample for test. Mayor Goette asked what are we going to do if the resident does not make the fix. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated the need to look what legally can be done.

13. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

    No Report

14. **Mayor and Council –**

    Council Member Drohan stated he had gotten his second shot and is waiting to see when he can return.

    Mayor Goette announced Town Hall will be closed January 18, 2021 for Martin Luther King Jr. Day.

15. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

    Mayor Goette asked for a motion and second to recess into executive session. **Council Member Williams made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

    Mayor Goette asked for a motion and second to return to open session. **Council Member Williams made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

    Council Member Williams recommended reme-helo purifying system for Town Hall, 800 per unit– three phase purifiers. The only additional cost is every 2 years the town must purchase peroxide replacement. The system cuts down on dust too. Council Member Drohan asked Council Member Williams to distribute the information to Council. Mayor Goette asked Interim Town Administrator Sims about other safety measures. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated staff is looking at plexiglass dividers, a temperature check kiosk and maybe foggers. If the purifying system is how Council wishes to go, foggers will not be needed. (Options need to not require staff to utilize with the Town being short staffed at this time).

    Mayor Goette asked for motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed unanimously.**

16. **Adjournment:**

    The meeting adjourned at 8:18 pm.

Mayor, Beth E. Goette

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion